torturing and killing an army officer. General Musharraf gave them a clean chit.

It can be concluded that religious extremism gave birth to sectarianism, sectarian terrorism and terrorism. The parties created for jihad in Afghanistan and Kashmir became a threat for internal peace of Pakistan. They influenced the entire society and the region, and only little efforts were made to control and neutralise them. However, military and civil authorities had different views and approaches to handle these elements. The military mainly overshadowed the civil desire to bridle the religious extremists and jihadis. Indian retaliation in the form of bomb blasts created a further dent in the serenity of the country. The act of localised violence in Karachi and Balochistan further worsened the situation. The people of Pakistan were helpless in the situation, which changed into an irreversible scenario.

These four factors, elaborated in Chapter 4, are the tools that facilitated the expansion of extremism and militancy in varying degrees at different stages. The linkages and collaboration of these four factors or tools strongly indicate an unabated crescendo in religious extremism due to the overpowering role of religious extremists, emboldened and empowered by weak writ and flawed policies of the state.